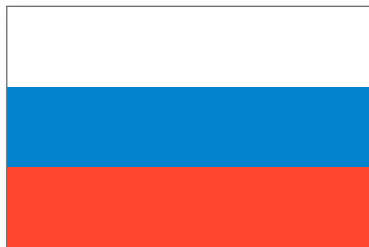


Russian Federation

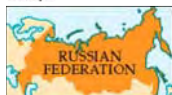
Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** August 22, 1991 **Usage:** National and Civil

The colors of the flag were originally the colors of Moscow. White, blue, and red are Pan-Slavic colors



Since its official adoption in 1799, the Russian tricolor has had a major influence on other east European flags

Europe



Russia was formed in the 15th century. The USSR was established in 1922 and included much of Asia. The USSR collapsed in 1991 and produced the **Russian Federation**.

At the end of the 17th century, Tsar Peter the Great of Russia visited western Europe. Following this visit he decided to adopt a variation of the Dutch flag as a civil ensign for Russian ships. This was a horizontal tricolor of white, blue, and red. It was only officially recognized in 1799. Peter the Great also adopted a flag for the Russian navy, which was white with the blue diagonal Cross of St. Andrew.

THE PAN-SLAVIC COLORS

Both the color and tricolor design of this first flag had a major influence on many of the flags of Eastern European nations during the 19th century, who looked to Russia for help in liberating

them from foreign domination. They have since become known as the Pan-Slavic colors.

THE HAMMER, SICKLE, AND STAR

After the Russian Revolution of 1917, the Communists abolished all former flags and instead adopted the Red Flag as the flag of the Soviet Union. This contained a gold hammer and sickle, symbols of the proletariat and the peasants, under a gold-edged red star, to represent unity. As a Soviet republic, Russia used this flag with a vertical blue bar at the hoist.

When the Soviet Union collapsed in 1991, the former flags of Russia, including the white, blue, and red tricolor were restored.